

God said, 'Let there be light!' Lo! it is created¹. He made darkness, and it became night. Observe! It is made². Fire in stones, water in rocks, The Being created them. There is one Power who raised them from nothing. Behold, even to-day, fire is not in a store-house in the earth. For lo! it is continually created by means of flints. It is the Being who ordains its existence by means of him who holds it. When He wishes He lights it, when He wishes He quenches it by way of appeal against the obstinate. In a great grove by the rubbing of a stick fire is kindled. The flame devours, it grows strong, at last sinks down. If fire and water are Beings and not creatures, then before the earth (was), where were their roots hid? Whoso would destroy his life, opens his mouth to speak concerning everything. Whoso hateth himself, and would not circumscribe God, holds it great impiety that one should think himself overwise. And if he thinks he has said the last thing he has reached heathenism. Oh, Bardaisān, whose mind is liquid like his name!

A. S. DUNCAN JONES.

¹ Lit. 'a created thing'.

² Lit. 'a made thing'.

INSCRIPTIONS FROM SHENOUTE'S MONASTERY.

THE following texts—only, I am told, a small part of the number still unstudied—were copied during the past spring by Canon W. T. Oldfield on two visits to the White Monastery¹. As Canon Oldfield disclaims any knowledge of Coptic, the accuracy of his copies is very remarkable, especially considering the dirty condition of the inscriptions and the bad light in which some of them stand.

The inscriptions may be described in two groups: (A) those in or beside the five niches of the north apse of the church², and upon one of the small walls between this and the central apse, and upon the domed roof of that apse; (B) those in the small room to the north of the central apse³, entered from the north apse by a narrow passage, and called by Canon Oldfield 'the Secret Chamber'. I here number the five niches *a* to *e*, counting from the most eastern. The inscriptions here are upon either the plastered facing of the interior of the niche or on the intervening brickwork. They are written partly in black,

¹ The best published account and plan of the building: W. de Bock *Matériaux pour servir à l'archéologie* &c. (1901) 39 ff; also, Gayet *L'Art Copte* 142. For Shenoute, v. Leipoldt's book (*cf.* this JOURNAL v 129).

² *Ih* in De B.'s plan.

³ *Ik* in De B.'s plan.

partly in red ; some apparently with a reed pen, others with a brush. Where the plaster has been chipped off there are signs of earlier lettering. It is much to be hoped that the government commission charged with the restoration of the Christian buildings in Egypt, will find means to examine and record these texts, which may well be of importance for the history of the monastery. (One of these earlier inscriptions appears below as A 11.)

Several of those in group A are dated, actually or by implication, in the twelfth and thirteenth centuries. As I have no palaeographical evidence, I can merely hazard the conjecture that the remainder are of the same period. From these dated texts we learn that the frescoes in the domes of the three apses—for all are, apparently, of one style¹—were executed at the beginning of the twelfth century, and that certain structural restorations were carried out about the middle of the thirteenth, though what exactly the latter were it is not easy now to determine². We further obtain information regarding several heads of the monastery, while two texts (A 1 and 2) shew the tradition as to the facts of Shenoute's career then officially accepted.

Group B, combined with Canon Oldfield's account of his interviews with the monks, establishes one fact of interest : namely, that the famous library of the monastery, the source of so great a part of the remains of Sa'idic literature, was stored in the 'secret chamber', in the north-east corner of the building³. Whether by the 'keep' (جوسق), mentioned by Abû Şâlih, this room is intended we cannot tell⁴. A three-shelved book-chest stood, according to the same writer⁵, in the church in the eighth century, but not necessarily, of course, in this room. The lists of books inscribed on the several walls (B 12 to 27) may indicate the relative positions once occupied by special chests or shelves. Thus it would seem that the New Testament MSS were ranged along the north side of the room, the homiletic and historical works along the east, the biographical along the west. Against the south wall, where only one text is legible, may have stood the Old Testament MSS.

In printing the texts I indicate tentative completions of gaps by square *brackets*, probable misreadings in the copies still requiring emendation by *sic*, letters doubtful in the copies and my suggested readings of such by *dots* below them. The copies do not allow of the exact

¹ De Bock questions the age of the apses themselves (*op. cit.* 56).

² Cf. Mr. Peers's note, appended to this article.

³ Not, as De B. thought, the room in the south-east corner. It is clearly to this 'secret' room that Maspero's description (*Mission franç.* vi p. 1) refers.

⁴ Fol. 82 b. The 'keep' was used elsewhere as library; v. Horner's *Bohairic Gospels* vol. i, lx. Sacristy, vestry, and library are sometimes one; v. Can. Basil. No. 96.

⁵ Fol. 83 b.

554 THE JOURNAL OF THEOLOGICAL STUDIES

length of the gaps being estimated; the brackets therefore enclose only approximate spaces.

A 1.

Between niches α and β . Enclosed in a simple line border. Red and black ink, alternating at asterisks. Ll. 1, 2 in ornamental lettering, red.

ен ономади тот патрос н,
[тот тид] н, тот асид пнатос*

тан. зiwч епи[с]хнеа етота[аб] о
н ктриакн н. [сот]з нtwбе [] . 2

5 жон ѿ прое[пе з]птецазе*. . пен
пиот апа [пw]л епапа пшo[и] аѿ†
еепсхнеа етотааб [аѿ]w аѿхротони^{sic}
[е]моу епре* аѿ пархнеатрит[нс] зити^{sic}
[тсiж] напа кертолос пархнепископ[ос]

10 [н]тполи ракоте* зиптоп[ос нпра]тис^{sic}
[ѿеоз]орос пестратнлат[нс знт]плис^{sic}
н[ос]тапаниотполис пжон ее . . . ромпе
. . . . * Ж ѿ аѿw аѿкот е[п] ееео
настнри еппсоотз ето пноѿ аѿw

15 [а]тратцазе еееос знше епсо пр[оee]
пе . ee. зепцазе* аѿw аѿеетон е[еeo]ч
[псот] з епехот епп Ж ѿ
. . . аѿw тепе епцазе тнрч

[жн]печжпо шатецапап[атсiс]*

20 [е]пехоте спат ер[е]н.
] . . . [е]тѿааб шоп.неср
] . . . инш*
] . . [еe]ркотр[и з]он[ра]фос
]ти епееонастнрион
25]ч еени*

[τ]μερϣομετε πχот
 [μεν]τι ρμεπεχροнос
 π[με]μεδ[ρ]τερ[ο]с ατω
 [τ]ανασταсис εντρομεπε
 [ετ]μεμεδτε сотχот μεϣμεотн
 [μεπαρ]μεотт[ε] ατω ενταϣ
 [μετον]μεμοϣ] ρ[н]τμερϣμε
 [μεнϣе] π[ροме]πε πχιονλε
 [πсот] ζ μεп]εβοτ ιεπнп
 [ατω αττο]μεсϣ енсот са[ϣϣ]
]none[
]т[

'And our holy father Apa Shenoute was born in the sixty-fifth (year), in the era (χρ.) of the Martyrs (μαρ.)¹. And Easter (ἀνάστασις) of that year was the 28th day of Parmoute. And he went to rest in the [1]70th (?) year of Diocle(tian), [on the 7th day of] the month Iepêp², [and he was] buried (?) on the 7th day . . . '

These *data* as to S.'s birth confirm one another: A.M. 65 = A.D. 349, when Easter did in fact fall on April 23 = Parmoute 28. But it is difficult to reconcile this with any of the calculations based upon older, though less precise, texts³.

A 3.

Beside the large painting of Christ in the dome of the central apse. As the text is accessible⁴, I give only a translation.

'Theodore, painter (ζωγράφος), of Terbebibe⁵:—May the Lord, Jesus,

¹ 'Fifth' is uncertain; but there seems no space for προμεπε. For the system of numeration ('the 3d twenty and 5') v. Piehl in *Aeg. Z.* xxxiii 130. In Clar. Press frag. 65 also 'eightieth' is expressed thus.

² Copy has τμεтϣμε.

³ v. Leipoldt *Schenute* 42 ff.

⁴ In de Bock *Matériaux* 58, and Turaief *Mater. po archeol. christ.* 1902, No. 52.

⁵ Terbe may be Ar. طرفة, a village west of Kolosana (Abû Šâlih 74b). But طرفية الجديد near Ashmunain occurs in the Acts of Ptolemy (Paris, Arabe 150 f. 102). In Coptic *Terbe* is found once but cannot be localized (Amélineau *Géogr.* 492). It contains the element ερμε έπαυλις. Ημε is obscure; cf. ! ΗΗΗ 'cave.' Presumably the Armenian artist resided there.

the Christ, bless and preserve the life of our God-loving, charity (ἀγάπη)-loving brother, the archdeacon Shenoute, the monk of this monastery (μοναστ.), the son of the late (μακάριος) Papnoute. For he it was did provide for this picture (λιμὴν¹), in the days of our father, Abba Paul², the archimandrite; my father Zekiêl being the second³ (in authority), Jesus (?) the Christ being king over us⁴. Era (χρόνῳ) of the Martyrs (μαρτύρων) 840' = A. D. 1124.

On the opposite side of the painting, an Armenian text forms a pendant to this⁵. It too commemorates Theodore, 'painter and scribe', native of Kesun in Armenia, and states that the work was executed in the time of Bishop Gregory, 'nephew of Gregory called Vahram'. The uncle here is the Catholicus of 1065-1105; the nephew the bishop of the then numerous Armenian colony in Egypt, mentioned by the patriarchal chronicler⁶ and by Abû Şâlih⁷.

A 4.

In niche β.

ατω πταει | εροτη επι[] | μοναστηριον | ενσοτ
 ροτ[τ]α | τε απιεβοτ | ιεπηη ρηφρο[απε] | ται Χ ρ
 Ζητ | ει . ου . . | παιοτε πε | ατεια | πρηρε εν |
 ρεπεθελλ[α] | πρεαα | ααλοτ | ερετ . . | πρηρε |
 αινα . | 1 line illegible.

'And I entered this . . . monastery (μοναστ.) on the 24th day of the month Iepêp⁸, in this year of the era (χρ.) of the Martyrs (μαρτ.) 953 (= A. D. 1237) . . . my fathers David, son of Hibat Allâh⁹, the man of Samalot (?)¹⁰, . . . son of Mina being . . .'

The year mentioned is the same as in the next.

¹ Cf. von Lemm in *Bull. de l'Acad. imp.* 1900, 57.

² Was in office twelve years earlier; v. the colophon of A. D. 1112, Brit. Mus. Or. 3581 B. 69.

³ i. e. δευτεράριος.

⁴ Reading, in Turaief's copy, 14. αϥηι, 20. παιοτ ρηκηνλ ω, 22. ερετ πεχς, 23. εραι εχον. I use a photograph kindly lent by Prof. Strzygowski.

⁵ Translated by Dashian in Strzygowski's *Kleinasiën* p. 202; v. also his *Dom zu Aachen* 42.

⁶ Renaudot *Hist.* 460, 491.

⁷ Ff. 2 a note, 47 b.

⁸ This spelling is characteristic; v. No. A 2.

⁹ Perhaps here a translation of 'Theodore'.

¹⁰ Fifteen miles north of Minyeh; but the reading is doubtful.

A 5.

In niche β.

[ατ]ω αηταπιακαθον | [ψο]ον [ριτ]ηη[ροοτ]ψ μενειοτ
 παρχνεπισκο | ποс αββα κηριλλος ερεχρις[τ]οτολ-
 λοτ | ο νεπισκοπος ετπολις σιοοττ ρητρωμεπε | ται
 χροποτ ^{sic}μαρτοροτ ζητ ατω επ | ταπειοοτ ει επι-
 ταλπερχε ηπαλ | καρσαρ επτπολις σιοοττ ενσοτ πτ |
 εεπιεβοτ ιεπηη ατω ατι επηκοτ | εντμεε τροηχε
 ησοτ μενταγτε εεπιεβοτ | ιεπηη ατω ταναστασις
 εντρομεπε | εταμεαττε σοτ χοτταγτε εεπιεβο[τ] |
 παρμεοττε ατω μενεν[с]οс ταναστασις | σοτ ψις
 εεπαρμεοττε ατω μενενсοс σοτ[α] | ·εεπαρμεοττε
 ατω ^{sic}μενενсοτ χοτ ε[επαρ] | μεοττε ατω μενενсοс
 соτ тт εεπαρμε[οττε] | ατω μεнενсοс соτ χοτ[ме]ε
 тт εε[п]α[ρ]μεοτте | ατω мененсοс соτ ме[нт]с[а]ψψ
 [εεπαρμεοτте] | ατω мененсοс соτ ψε[μεοτη εεπαρ-
 меοτте] | ατω мененсοс соτ χο[τοτε

‘And this good-work (ἀγαθόν) was done by the care of our father the archbishop, Abba Cyril¹, Christodulus being bishop of the city (πολ.) Siut, in this (*sic*) year of the era (χρ.) of the Martyrs (μαρτ.) 953 (= A. D. 1237). And the water (*i. e.* the inundation) reached the lake (?)² of the . . .³ of the city of Siut on the 13th day of the month Iepêp; and it reached our little village of Tronche⁴ on the 14th day of the month Iepêp. And Easter (ἀνάστασις) of that year (was on) the 24th day of the month Parmoute⁵. And afterwards’—here follows a list of Easter dates, in successive years⁶: 9th Parmoute, 1st Parm., 20th Parm., 5th Parm., 25th [Parm.], 17th [Parm.], 8th [Parm.], 21st [Parm.].

The practical object of thus recording the dates of coming Easters is not clear.

¹ Cyril b. Laklak, 1235-43.

² بركة preceded by ? ἐπί.

³ ‘Castles’ قصور, whatever that may here mean; or (less likely) قياسر ‘bazars’, a word used by Ibn Duqmāq (v 23) in describing Siut.

⁴ Udrunkah, Doronka, about two-and-a-half miles south-west of Siut. Cf. A 9.

⁵ *i. e.* April 19, which is correct.

⁶ These correspond to Apr. 4, Mar. 27, Apr. 15, Mar. 31, Apr. 20, 12, 3, and 16, which are the correct dates for 1238 to 1245.

A 6.

On small wall S. of entrance to 'secret chamber'.

αὐτῷ ῥιπτεπρονία [αὐτῷ] γὰρ ἄλλ
 [νοῦτε] πῶπαντοκράτ[ωρ ἀς] ἀνοκεῖ
 [π]]τε. π[]λ
]ἀβ[

5 αὐ]ω παρχνεατρι[τη]ς·

[**ⲁⲗ**]ⲡⲓ[]. ⲓ. ⲁⲧⲁⲛⲟⲩ · ⲛⲉⲛⲧⲟϥ ϩⲓⲧⲏⲧⲉϥ
 ⲥⲡⲟⲧⲁⲛ · ⲁϥϥⲓⲣⲟⲟⲩⲩⲱ ⲡⲧⲉⲓϥⲧⲟ ⲛⲥⲧ[]ⲉⲁϥ
 ⲛⲱⲛ ⲉⲡⲏⲃⲁⲣⲏ · ϩⲏⲛⲓⲥⲉⲛⲧⲉ ⲡⲓⲕⲱⲧⲏ
 ⲁⲛⲡⲓⲕⲱⲧⲏ ⲉⲧⲁⲡⲉⲧⲕⲱⲧⲉ ⲧⲓϥⲟⲣⲏ [**ⲁⲗⲉⲛ**]

10 αψχοκς εβολ · ρησοτ ϩε απεβοτ [ετεπε]
βοτ θοοτα οη · αψχεκ τηροτε[ι ρητιροαπε]
ται ϫ ϩε [erased] ρηπεροοτ απεν[ιωτ]

αββα αθανασιος πατριαρχεις πρα[κότες ερε αβ]
βα ιωσηφ ποσιотатос о непископос ет[πολις]

15 **παλος** · ατω πτοϋ πενταϋριτοοτϋ **πενταϋ** **μ**[ηπνεσνιτ]
τη[ρο]τ : **ψαντοτσειντοτ** · **ρημιροοτ** **ετσοομ**[ε πτ]
μντερο **ηντοτρποс** · ατω **πταπαγαοον** **ψωπε** **ρηт**

μερ^{sic}κ̅α προεπε πωτ αββα ιωαννης εχο παρχηγος εφ
 στναγωγη ταλ·ατω παλ πωωρπ αφρεμοναχος ραλειμονα

20 ТИРІОН ПАПА ЯВѢСНЄ ЯВНЄСѢ АПНОТТЕ ТѢРѢ[ЕУ РИ]
 ПЕРОУ ЯВЕНІУТ АВѢА КТРИЛЛОС ЖЕНОУ ПЕНТАУ[ААУ ЯВ
 РЕШѢТЕРОС · АТѢ ПАРХИНОС ЕФѢПАТѢСН ЯВЕНІУТ Я
 П[РОФНТНЄ]

^{sic} ἀπὰ ψυχοῦτε · ^{sic} ρετρετοταεκαρ οτωεε νηηεα εεν[η]
 ατρε απεα σωλπ εβολ · ητοϋ εε εενηιοτε εεν[η]εεν[η]το

25 α[τα]ατ ηκесоп · ерепποtte нпе †^{sic}τοε παυ ηу† па[
ποταρε]

пѣрнѣиконъ • пѣсѣвѣю пѣсѣхъх[е
]пѣсѣроисъ епѣснѣнѣтѣ [

‘And by the foresight (πρόνοια) and love (ἀγάπη) of God Almighty (παντοκ.), it seemed good to [NN, . . . , the] and archimandrite For he it was, in his zeal (σπουδή), did provide these four columns (?)¹, finishing the canopies (or ceilings²) in the two tabernacles (σκηνή³) and the chambers (κύπη⁴) that are beside them. The first he finished on the 29th day of this same (?) month Thoth; the other in this [year,] era (χρ.) of the Martyrs (μαρτ.) , in the days of our father, Abba Athanasius, the Patriarch (πατρ.) of Alexandria⁵, the most saintly (δοσιότατος) Abba Joseph being bishop of the city (πόλις) Panos (Achmîm). And he it was (sc. Joseph) assisted him with all [the brethren], till they had constructed them, in the evil (lit. perverted) days of the kingship of the Turks (τουρνος⁶). And this good-work (ἀγαθόν) was done in the twenty-fourth year that our father Abba John was director (ἀρχηγός) of this congregation (συναγωγή)⁷. And he was first a monk in the monastery (μον.) of Apa Moses⁸. Afterwards God called him (?), in (?) the days of our father, Abba Cyril⁹; for he it was [made? him] priest (πρεσβ.) and director (ἀρχηγός) for the congregation (συν.) of our father, the prophet (προφ.), Apa Shenoute. After that the earthquake¹⁰ had swallowed the buildings (or rooms or dwellings) and [the] . . . , they found the place uncovered¹¹; and he and the fathers and the brethren did [make] them again. May the God of heaven strengthen him and give him a peaceful (εἰρηνικόν) life and subdue his enemies . . . he watch over the brethren’

¹ The fem. pronoun, if correct, forbids στῦλος. Perhaps στήλη.

² A rare word; v. Ps. cxvii 27 = πυκάζων, which the *Triadon* (ed. von Lemm, p. 26) translates ‘the heights’, الأعالى. In Zoega 618, referring to the hangings of the Tabernacle, it may be ‘curtain’. The primary meaning is ‘to cover’; cf. Ps. civ 2.

³ Here probably the space wherein an altar stands; cf. Abū Ṣāliḥ ff. 2 a, 27 b (dome over it), 30 b (altar in it), 31 a (north and south s.), 33 a (its threshold), 61 b (= sanctuary). In *Mission franç.* iv 458 it is the sanctuary, shut in by doors. The northern and southern apses suggest themselves, as the side-altars may have stood there, and Zoega pp. 107, 108 (lessons read in the southern σκηνή) supports this.

⁴ v. von Lemm, *Bull. de l'Ac. Imp.* xiii 159. Cf. Arab. قَبْو (also قَبْوَة), as in Abū Ṣāliḥ 2 a.

⁵ Athanasius III, 1250-61.

⁶ i.e. the Bahri Mamluks. An inscription of A.D. 1173 (*Rec. de Trav.* vii 218) refers to the Ayyūbid rule in the same words.

⁷ Cf. A 7.

⁸ At Belyanā; v. my notes on the graffiti there in M. A. Murray *The Osireion*, 1904.

⁹ The notorious Cyril b. Laqlāq, 1235-43.

¹⁰ A new word, fem. like other compounds of στωα. A great earthquake in 1112 is recorded (*Synax.* Tūt 3; Renaudot *Hist.* 490).

¹¹ Cf. Leyden *MSS coptes* 443 αα ετσολεπ εβολ.

Assuming that A 7 is of the same year as this text, the date of John's instalment as director (? abbot) would be 1235, the first year of Cyril's patriarchate. Presumably John is also the archimandrite commemorated in the first lines here.

A 7.

Between niches α and β .

πποττε ροεис εποηρ αεπενιωτ | παρχημεατритис ·
 αββα ιωρ | χεντοу пентауχι роотш | αηνεςπнт
 тнрот епσινκωт | η†спте ηсктнн · αηηсапσωλп |
 εβολ ηпес^{sic}βαρεп · ποτ ιс χс † ηαу | ποταρε ηпн-
 ннон αηνεςпнт тнрδ | αηηп ποот ηαι ζ ηешир |
 ✠ ✠ 70ε,

'God, watch over the life of our father the archimandrite, Abba John. For he it was did, with all the brethren, provide for the building of the (or these) two tabernacles (σκηνή), after the uncovering of their¹ canopies (or ceilings). Lord Jesus Christ, give unto him a peaceful (εἰρηνικόν) life and (unto) all the brethren. Amen. To-day is the 7th of Emshir, era (χρ.) of the Martyrs (μарт.) 975² (= A.D. 1259).'

Apparently records the same work as that in A 6.

A 8.

In niche δ .

αηπρн | с . η ешжеотатσоепе етρεпκωрт тоρ
 αηпπео αη | отатσоеη де ρωηпе етρεтρоте αη-
 πпоттё | τωρ αηптeотнс αηпсωαα · от[οι] ηαι αηон |
 жешареотвейш шωпе ηαιшoop αη | песραι ηαηотн
 εβολ · ηтeпσix таκω | ρηптафос ∴ αρι ηαηеет
 ηαгапe ηαιωте | αηηαспнт αηон ηеβннн ηеттeλис |
 ηетσoσb ρηηспpазис ηαтeпшa | αηпpαη жерωαα
 ααλιστα жeλ[ακωп] | a line erased | ηρс ηт⁰_λ ααααи-

¹ Reading ηпeт-.

² The printed sign for 900 but distantly resembles that written.

πε̅χρ̅ς λατων ετεςνητε | तेनोत् दे एिसोप्स मेोत्
 ατω ει† नेत्न पोत्шо | मेेतानοια ψαοτεप्с енсоп
 नाऱोते | मेनपसन्त मेनोतोन नीε ετनाव् π . . | . λος
 ма[р]ψχοос ρποταγαπε κρηт | मेनोत्मेετε εναποत्
 जेप्ने ऐऐ[р]||πκпа मेεεαψ ριτηνψληλ मेन[ιω]т |
 ετοτααδ̅ मेπροφ̅нτες αпа ψεпоtte | ажис मेεεαν
 тртн ριοтсоп жед̅ени | κ[α] ϣ̅ϑ̅ εψ[ε]ψωπε ποот πα
 ϣοτ 7- [μεп] | εβοτ επ̅нп ϣ̅ [ψ̅] 7 . . | *Space.*

Then eight lines, very imperfect. The first contains οτσοφος, the third οτρωμε αψρηωε, the fifth επιστολη.

‘. . . .’ If it be impossible that fire should mix with water, so is it also impossible that the fear of God should mix with the pleasure of the body (σωμα). Woe is me! For a time will be when I shall not be. The writing shall endure; the hands shall perish in the tombs². Remember me in kindness (ἀγάπη), my fathers and my brethren, me, the poor and vile (ἐντελής), that is feeble in his deeds (πρᾶξις), unworthy of the name of man, much more (μάλιστα) of deacon priest (πρεσβ.) of the Christ-loving city (πολ.) Latôn which is Snê (Esneh). So (δέ) now I do entreat you and make to you a thousand obeisances (μετάνοια) many times, my fathers and my brethren and every one who shall read³, that he say with kindness (ἀγ.) of heart and good thoughts: God, do thou shew Thy mercy upon him, through the prayers of our holy father the prophet (προφ.) Apa Shenoute. Say with us, all ye together: Amen 21 (times)⁴, 99 (= Amên), so be it. To-day is the 7th of the month Epêp, era (χρ.) of the Martyrs (μαρ.) 9 . . .’

The date falls between 1184 and 1284.

A 9.

In niche β.

αρι παμεετε πακα | पे अनक पिरेने | रेपना अτω
 पिरेमे | माव रेपकोवे पा | तेम्या मेोत्ते роψ |

¹ This line may end a former text.

² This formula in a scribe's colophon of A.D. 1112, from this monastery, Brit. Mus. Or. 3581 B. 69; and something similar in Arabic, Hyvernat *Album* p. 16.

³ ? στῦλος.

⁴ κα or κ., Cf. de Bock *Matériaux* p. 65, and Turaief *Materialie* No. 55.

ⲭ[ⲉⲁ]ⲓⲁ, . ⲓⲟⲗⲁⲛⲛⲉⲥ | ⲡⲩⲛⲣⲉ ⲙⲉⲡⲉⲁⲕⲁⲣⲓⲟⲥ ⲣⲁⲫⲁⲛⲗ |
 ⲡⲣⲉⲙⲧⲣⲟⲛⲡ · ⲛⲥ ⲛⲧⲡⲟⲗⲓⲥ | [ⲥⲓ]ⲟⲟⲩⲧ ⲟⲩⲟⲓ [ⲛ]ⲁⲓ ⲭⲉⲩⲁ-
 ⲣⲉⲟⲩⲱⲉⲩⲱ | ⲩⲟⲡⲉ ⲛⲧ[ⲓⲛⲁⲩⲟⲟⲛ ⲁⲛ] ⲩⲱⲣⲉⲡⲉⲥⲟⲗ[ⲁⲓ] ⲙⲉⲟⲩⲛ
 ⲉⲃⲟⲗ ⲉⲛⲧⲟⲩⲓⲭ ⲧⲁⲕⲟ [

‘Remember me in kindness (ἀγάπη), me, the poor in grace, the rich in sin, that am not worthy to be called deacon, John, son of the late (μακάριος) Raphael, the inhabitant of Tronpês¹ of the city (πολ.) Siout. Woe is me! For a time will be when I shall not be. The writing shall endure, the hands shall perish²’

A 10.

Beside a much-begrimed painting, over the door leading to the ‘secret chamber’.

ⲡⲟⲥ ⲓⲥ ⲡⲉⲭⲥ ⲉⲥⲉ | ⲗⲁⲣⲉⲗ ⲉⲡⲱⲛⲟⲗ | [ⲙ]ⲛⲧⲁⲗⲟ ⲉⲣⲁ |
 ⲧⲉ · ⲙⲉⲡⲉⲛⲓⲱ[ⲧ] | ⲉⲧⲧⲁⲓⲛⲧ ⲁⲃ | ⲃⲁ ⲫⲓⲃⲁⲙⲙⲟⲛ | ⲡⲉⲡⲣⲉⲥⲃⲧ-
 ⲧⲉ | ⲣⲟⲥ ⲁⲩⲱ ⲡⲉⲟ | ⲛⲁⲭⲟⲥ ⲛⲧⲉⲗⲓ | ⲟⲥ ⲡⲓⲥⲧⲛⲕ[ⲣ]ⲁ | ⲫⲉⲧⲥ ·
 ⲁⲩⲱ ⲡ | ⲥⲁⲗ ⲡⲉⲕⲱⲧ · | ⲡⲩⲛⲣⲉ ⲕⲁⲧⲁ | ⲥⲁⲣⲗ ⲙⲉⲡⲁⲣ[ⲭⲓ] |
 ⲁⲓⲁⲕⲟⲛ · ⲭ[ⲁⲛⲗ] | ⲡⲩⲛⲣⲉ ⲙⲉⲡ[ⲛⲁⲡⲁ] | ⲃⲓⲕⲧⲱⲣ ⲡⲣⲉⲃⲥ |
 ⲡⲟⲗⲓⲥ ⲙⲙⲁⲓⲭⲣⲥ | ⲩⲙⲉⲛ ⲭⲉⲛⲧⲟⲩⲉ ⲟⲗ[ⲙ] | ⲡⲉⲩ[ⲙ]ⲉ
 ⲉⲗⲟⲩⲛ ⲉⲡⲛⲟⲩ[ⲧⲉ] · ⲟⲗ | ⲁⲩⲓ ⲣⲟⲟⲩ[ⲩ] · ⲙⲉⲡ[ⲓⲗⲓⲙⲉⲛⲛ
 ⲙ | ⲡⲁⲣⲭⲛⲁⲧⲧⲉ[ⲗⲟⲥ ⲙⲓⲭⲁⲛⲗ] | ⲭ[ⲉⲩ]ⲉⲥⲟⲡⲥ ⲉⲭ[|
 ⲣⲙⲙ · ⲛⲟ [| ⲛⲩⲭ[| ⲉⲓⲣⲛⲓⲛ ⲟⲩⲛⲥ [| [ⲛⲓⲱⲧ]
 ⲁⲃⲃⲁ ⲩⲉⲛⲟⲩⲧⲉ [|] ⲧⲁⲥ ⲁⲩⲟⲛ · ⲙⲙⲙⲟⲛ[ⲁⲥⲧⲛ-
 ⲣⲓⲟⲛ] |] ⲟⲩⲙⲙ ⲛⲁⲩ · ⲁⲙⲉⲛⲛ [|

‘May the Lord Jesus Christ watch over the life and firm establishment of our honoured father, Abba Phaebammon, the priest (πρεσβ.) and perfect (τέλειος) monk, the writer (συγγραφεύς³) and master builder⁴, the son according to the flesh (κατὰ σάρξ) of the archdeacon (ἀρχιδ.) Chaël (?), son of the papa Victor, inhabitant of the Christ-loving city

¹ Cf. A 5, Tronche. Presumably the copy here is in error.

² Cf. A 8.

³ In the Paris *scala* 44, p. 2 h b, this (= الكاتب) occurs among ecclesiastical officers, between καλλιογράφος (الناسخ) and ζωγράφος.

⁴ Cf. ⲥⲁⲗ ⲡⲁⲛⲫⲓⲛⲉ Zoega 549, ⲧⲉⲭⲛⲡⲓⲧⲛⲥ ⲡⲥⲁⲗ Rossi *Papiri di Torino* II i 70.

564 THE JOURNAL OF THEOLOGICAL STUDIES

(πολ.) Shmin (Panopolis). For he, in his love toward God . . . , provided [this picture of] the archangel (ἀρχηγ.) [Michael?]; that [he might?] pray for . . . [father], Abba Shenoute . . . holy (ἅγιον) monastery . . . Amen.'

A 11.

Between niches δ and ε, on a space where the upper, later plaster has fallen away.

ⲕⲉ ⲙⲏ ⲁ[ⲡ]ⲟⲣⲧⲩⲧⲉⲧ ⲉⲃ ⲟⲩⲁ
 ⲧⲟⲧ ⲡⲣⲟⲥⲟⲡⲟ[ⲧ] ⲥⲟⲧ ⲁⲡ[ⲟ]
 ⲧⲟⲧ ⲁⲟⲧⲗⲟ[ⲧ] ⲥⲟⲧ
 ⲡ ⲁⲓⲧⲗⲟⲓⲥⲁ . ⲡ
 ⲙⲉⲣ . ⲟⲧⲁⲓ

Apparently an inexact quotation from a Psalm¹.

B.

The following numbers are in the 'secret chamber'. North wall.

B 12. ⲡⲉⲧⲣⲁⲉⲧⲁⲛⲉ | ⲗⲓⲟⲛ ⲧⲉⲧⲉⲡⲏ | . ⲡⲉ ⲡⲣⲟⲧⲓ
 ⲙⲏⲛⲛⲟⲥ | ⲡⲓⲣⲧⲕⲉ ⲡⲡⲁ ⲕⲗⲁⲧⲧⲉ | ⲧⲧ ⲡⲁⲗⲏⲧ ⲕⲟⲧ ⲡⲁⲓ
 ⲉⲃⲟⲗ, 'the Four-gospels². Their number, -59, the small and large (together). The poor ⲡⲁⲡⲁ Claudius, son (ⲡⲓⲟⲥ) of Palêu³; forgive me.' The first numeral is illegible. So large a number of gospels is remarkable.

B 13. ⲧⲣⲁⲉⲧⲁⲛⲉ^{sic}ⲗⲓⲟⲛ ⲡⲣⲟⲧⲓ | ⲡⲡⲟⲥ ⲡ ⲡⲁⲧⲕⲟⲉⲓⲣⲧ . ⲓ,
 'The Four-gospels, the small and the large (together), 50; those without bindings (?)⁴, 10.'

B 14. ⲡⲕⲁⲑⲟⲗⲓⲟⲛ ⲙⲏⲛⲉⲡⲣⲁⲗⲓⲥ — ⲡⲁⲓⲛⲉ ⲡⲉⲡⲣⲁⲗⲓⲥ
^{sic}ⲡⲁⲡⲟⲥⲧⲟⲗⲟⲥ, 'The Catholic (Epistles) and the Acts—These are the Acts of the Apostles'.

East wall: B 15. ⲡⲗⲟⲕⲟⲥ ⲡⲁⲣⲭⲉⲉⲡⲓⲥⲕⲟⲡⲟⲥ ⲙⲏⲛⲉⲙⲉⲁⲛⲟ-

¹ Cf. Ps. xxvi (xxvii) 9.

² Τετραεὺς ἀγγέλιον.

³ Presumably the writer of these inscriptions or the librarian. Cf. B 20.

⁴ Generally 'sheaths'. I do not know of evidence that Coptic like Ethiopic books were ever encased in leathern slip-cases.

Claudius, son (*viós*) of Miskin¹: Apa Bêsa², the patriarch Severus³, Apa Pisenthius⁴, John Cólobus, Apa Pamin, Archellides⁵, Apa Elias⁶, Apa Abraham⁷, the . . . of Apa . . . , Apa Zenobius⁸, Apa Matthew⁹, Cyril and . . . , the . . . our father (?) Shenoute⁸ (copies), Apa Apollo¹⁰, the Apostles¹¹, Apa Matthew the Poor.⁷

A book list similar to the next. Fragments of several of them are preserved.

B 23.

ⲡⲃⲓⲟⲥ ⲡ[ⲛ]ⲛⲉⲧⲟⲧⲁⲃ^{sic} ⲁⲡⲁ ⲡⲁⲣⲱ[ⲙ] ⲛ̅ ⲁⲡⲁ ⲉⲡ. . ⲁⲡⲁ
ⲙⲁⲣⲛⲟⲥ ⲁⲡⲁ ⲙⲱⲉⲥⲛⲉ ⲛ̅ ⲁⲡⲁ ⲥⲓⲙⲱⲛ ⲁⲡⲁ ⲛⲉⲡⲣⲓⲁⲛⲟⲥ
ⲁⲡⲁ ⲥⲁⲙⲉⲟⲧⲛⲓⲗ ⲁⲡⲁ ⲑⲉⲱⲧⲟⲣⲟ[ⲥ] ⲁⲡⲁ ⲉⲣⲉⲙⲉⲙⲉ^{sic} ⲁⲡⲁ
^{sic} ⲉⲱⲙⲙ ⲙⲛⲉⲣⲟⲣ[ⲥⲓⲥ]ⲓⲟⲥ ⲙⲛⲉⲟⲣⲟⲣⲟⲥ ⲡⲉⲭⲟⲧⲧⲁⲃⲧⲉ ⲙⲡⲣ̅ⲥ-
ⲃⲛⲧⲛⲣⲟⲥ ⲁⲡⲁ ⲃⲛⲥⲁ ⲉⲧⲃⲉ[ⲡ]ⲧⲟⲧⲛⲛⲟⲥⲱⲙⲙ ⲉⲣⲣⲁⲓ ⲙⲡ-
[ⲡⲉ]ⲛⲓⲱⲧ ⲁⲡⲁ ⲱⲛⲟⲧⲧⲉ^{sic}

'The Lives (*βίος*) of the Saints: Apa Pachôm 20 (copies), Apa Ep . . .¹², Apa Marcus, Apa Moses¹³ 2 (copies), Apa Simon¹⁴, Apa Cyprianus¹⁵, Apa Samuel¹⁶, Apa Theodorus¹⁷, Apa Hermime¹⁸, Apa Pahôm with Horsiesius and Theodorus¹⁹, The twenty-four Elders²⁰,

¹ مسكين. The same scribe probably in B 20, though the father's name there is different. ² No life of B. is known.

³ Perhaps the work, complete in Ethiopic, of which there are Coptic fragments. *v.* this JOURNAL v 130 note.

⁴ Fragments of a Sa'id. Life, but on papyrus (Crum *Copt. Ostr.* xiii note). No parchment fragments are known.

⁵ No life as yet recognized (*cf.* *Synax.* 14th Tube).

⁶ I cannot identify this.

⁷ Abraham of Pboou.

⁸ One of Shenoute's disciples and (?) successors; *Fragts.* Paris MS. 129¹³ ff. 9-11.

⁹ Not M. the Poor; *v.* below.

¹⁰ ? Of Bawit. No life known.

¹¹ ? Apocryphal Acts.

¹² Epime (martyr) would fill the gap. A Bohairic *Passio*, Zoega p. 22.

¹³ Of Abydos or Belyanâ (*v.* my notes in M. A. Murray *The Osireion*, 1904).

¹⁴ ? The Canaanite, whose body was said to lie in the White Monastery (Abû Şâlih 82 a).

¹⁵ Of Antioch. *Fragts. ed.* von Lem.

¹⁶ Of Kalamôn.

¹⁷ ? Stratelates or Anatoleus.

¹⁸ ? Herminos; *v.* Abû Şâlih 73 b note. An anchorite so named occurs in some Apophthegmata, Brit. Mus. Or. 6004.

¹⁹ Presumably this is the combined version of the Lives; *v.* Ladeuze *Pakhom* 48; Butler *Lausiac Hist.* I 291.

²⁰ *Fragts.* of Encomia by Proclus and (Cyril?) of Jerusalem, *Mission franç.* I 404, Clar. Press No. 42, Brit. Mus. Or. 3581 A. 93.

Apa Bêsa concerning the resurrection of the body (σῶμα), and our father Apa Shenoute¹.

Almost all these works are still partly extant among the fragments brought from the White Monastery.

B 24. On the left of B 23. Little is legible. Apparently a list of Lives or possibly Encomiums. '. . . the ship (?)', 'Raphael', 'Za[charias] the priest' can be read.

B 25. **πῆλιος [π]απα μωυσης**, 'The Lives of Apa Moses'. Does this refer to various biographies or merely to the number of copies?

B 26. **δατερα περρο · ιϛ**, 'King David, thirteen (copies)'. If this is the Psalter, it is an unusual way of designating it.

B 27. **παινε ηκοου**, 'These are the Synods'. But the word has not usually this meaning. It is often used by Shenoute for 'congregation', *συναγωγή*.

B 28. Commemorates perhaps the scribe or librarian. 'Remember me in charity (*ἀγάπη*), my fathers and my brethren, every one that shall read (*sic*). I, the sinful' [

B 29, 30, 31 are the protective charms, above alluded to; traces of another copy are recognizable on the south wall. The copies are intended to be identical; certain divergences in orthography may shew that they were written from dictation, by different scribes. That they are in Arabic, though in Coptic characters, is clear from the one phrase which can be transcribed and translated with certainty (**αἰσπος** &c., ll. 3, 4). In l. 1 Moses appears to be either adjured or (as often in such texts) to be the narrator, and in l. 2 perhaps his 'curse' occurs². I cannot discern against what intruders the incantation is directed; in l. 2 perhaps 'the worm' and 'die' are to be read. In l. 3 the words 'the living, who dieth not' might be an allusion to Mk. ix 48. They are followed immediately by a new sentence: 'Go forth from this house'. At the end of l. 4 the being addressed is committed to the flames. L. 5 ends perhaps with 'men and stones.' L. 6 consists of imperatives (and perhaps vocatives), bidding the unwelcome visitor be gone.

¹ Or read **[π]κοτ ηπεςωμια εγραμ μ[πε]πωτ**, 'The decease of our father &c.', which might refer to Bêsa's Life of S.

² In a colophon from the White Monastery (Brit. Mus. Or. 3581 B. 70) a remover of the volume is threatened with all the curses of Moses and the Law.

Little can be said of the system of transcription followed until more as to the exact value of the words has been ascertained. Three aspirates are employed, including noticeably the Bohairic ⲕ. ⲙ seems to be represented by ⲭ, as in the Cambridge fragment¹. ⲭ corresponds clearly to ⲉ², while ⲭ, which represents it in the Cambridge frag., does not occur. ⲡ represents ⲃ as usual, and ⲉ occasionally ⲧ.

The text of B 29 is here given, with all variants from the others below it. The division of lines is that of B 29; the other texts divide where vertical strokes are here inserted. There are a few doubtful points in Canon Oldfield's readings, due to ambiguity in the script, notably where ⲕ and ⲓ ⲥ are confused.

¹ Ed. Casanova in *Bull. de l'Inst. franç. (Cairo)* I 1.

² This recalls the transcriptions in Stern's alchemistic tract (*Aeg. Z.*, 1885, 102), which likewise came from Achmim. It will be remembered that, in the mouth of Shenoute—or rather, of his copyists—the sound of ⲉ seems practically identical with those of ⲧ and ⲕ.

B 29. ⲁⲗⲓⲙⲉⲣⲉⲛⲓⲙⲓⲟⲩⲥⲏⲭⲉⲗⲗⲏⲙⲉⲣⲉⲩⲉⲗⲉⲣⲁⲩ

B 30. ⲗⲏ ⲙⲉ | ⲓ

B 31. ⲗⲓⲉ ⲗ ⲏ ⲁ

29. ⲧⲓ · ⲓⲭⲏⲏ · ⲟⲩⲁⲗⲥⲣⲓⲙⲟⲩⲥⲏ . . ⲉⲓⲛⲁⲓⲉⲧⲟⲩⲧⲓ · ⲟⲩ

30. ⲓⲛⲭ · | ⲁⲩⲁⲣⲙ ⲏⲩⲉⲉⲓ | ⲙⲟⲩⲟ

31. ⲓⲛⲭ · | ⲁⲩ · ⲁⲙ ⲏⲩⲉⲉⲓⲥⲣⲁⲓ ⲙⲟⲩⲧ

29. ⲡⲉⲣⲁⲁⲛⲉⲗⲣⲉⲉⲓⲗⲗⲉⲩⲗⲉⲓⲉⲙⲟⲩⲧⲁⲩⲣⲟⲩⲙⲏ

30. ⲏⲁⲓⲗⲉ | ⲓⲉⲙ ⲙⲏⲣⲉ

31. ⲏ ⲓ ⲉⲩⲗⲓⲉⲙ ⲙⲏⲣⲉ

29. ⲧⲉⲗⲙⲏⲩⲉⲗⲟⲩⲉⲓⲗⲗⲉⲁⲩⲣⲁⲓⲥⲟⲉⲓⲥⲁⲧⲙ

30. ⲗ | ⲉ ⲓ ⲥ ⲁⲛⲟⲉⲛⲟⲩⲙ

31. ⲗ | ⲉ ⲥ ⲓⲥⲟⲉⲛⲟⲩⲙ

¹ عليهم عظيم موسى. ² كلم فجعله. ³ وحرّم موسى سيقى الدود. ⁴ الموت. ⁵ يحيى. ⁶ للمّى الذى لايموت. ⁷ اخرج من هذا المنزل.

29. ¹πεπαρε²νοτεισο³τρτερε⁴ι⁵νη⁶σο⁷τε⁸ι⁹λ . ι¹⁰σα . . ρ

30. π | εκο¹ττε²ρε³ι⁴ τ . . ρ . σα⁵ρε⁶ρ |

31. π | ει¹σο²ττι³ρε⁴ι⁵ τε⁶ε⁷λ⁸ρ⁹ι¹⁰σ ρ

29. χ¹ο²τ³χ⁴ι⁵τ⁶α⁷ε⁸ψ⁹χ¹⁰ι¹¹τ¹²α¹³ε¹⁴ψ¹⁵χ¹⁶ι¹⁷τ | α¹⁸δ¹⁹ρο²⁰σ²¹α²²δ²³ρο²⁴σ²⁵α²⁶δ²⁷ρο²⁸σ

30. χ¹ο²τ³χ⁴ι⁵τ⁶α⁷ε⁸ι⁹ ι¹⁰τ | ι¹¹τ

31. χ¹ι²τ α³ε . ι τ |

كف كفيت⁴ . والحجارة³ . الناس² . والى آخرك¹ تقم بنار¹ .
 اخرج⁶ . شقذ⁵ ! From⁵

Mr. C. R. Peers, who has made on the spot an architectural study of the White Monastery, the results of which he will shortly publish (in *Archaeological Journal*, 1904), has kindly sent me the following observations upon the two inscriptions A 6 and 7:—‘The texts seem to refer to the building and not the fittings: the work is clearly something fairly large. An earthquake shook down the roof of the church—not the canopy of an altar—and a new roof had to be provided. Timber of sufficient size was probably unattainable; but bricks were always plentiful. So the new roof took the form of brick domes—the ‘canopies’ or ‘ceilings’ of the texts. And, in order to lessen the diameter of the domes, they were made to spring from piers and arches of brick, built within the lines of the old walls. The four ‘columns’¹ mentioned in A 6 are probably to be identified with the four massive brick piers which carry the dome over the eastern bay of the church. The inscription in question appears to be upon the north-eastern of these piers. Whether the work finished on the 29th of Thoth was this pier or the dome over the eastern bay is not clear; it seems more likely that it was the dome². The two σκηναί would be the two bays of the church then roofed in: that is, the eastern bay and that next it to the west. These are still thus covered, and are the only part of the building still in use as a church.”

W. E. CRUM.

¹ I must emphasize the uncertainty of the reading here.—[W. E. C.]

² Such a small affair as the leg of an altar-canopy would not have been worth recording.